
4.4 Unit 4, Topic B: Other Ideological Traditions

Focus This topic examines the ideological traditions that have developed out of, or emerged in opposition to, liberalism, conservatism and socialism.

What students need to learn: *Students taking Unit 4, Topic B must learn all areas within the topic.*

Nationalism

Key concepts	Content explanation
nation nation-state racialism patriotism national self-determination	■ A knowledge of the core ideas, doctrines and theories of nationalism and of the variety of nationalist traditions and their different political manifestations. ■ An understanding of different types of nationalism and the extent to which nationalism relates to other ideological traditions.

Feminism

Key concepts	Content explanation
sex/gender gender equality patriarchy public/private divide essentialism	■ A knowledge of the core ideas, doctrines and theories of feminist thought, of tensions within feminism and of competing feminist traditions, notably an understanding of the distinctive features of liberal feminism, socialist/Marxist feminism and radical feminism, and also taking into account more recent developments.

Ecologism

Key concepts	Content explanation
ecology 'hard/soft' ecology deep/shallow ecology environmentalism holism sustainability industrialism social ecology anthropocentrism	■ A knowledge of the core ideas, doctrines and theories of ecological and environmentalist political thinking. ■ An understanding of the range of ecological traditions and differences between them, focusing in particular on conservative/authoritarian ecologism, eco-socialism, eco-anarchism and eco-feminism.

Multiculturalism

Key concepts	Content explanation
communitarianism post-colonialism identity politics minority rights toleration diversity pluralism cosmopolitanism	■ A knowledge of the core ideas, doctrines and theories of multiculturalist political thinking, and an understanding of the range of multiculturalist views and their relationship to political stances such as liberalism, pluralism and cosmopolitanism. ■ A critical understanding should also be demonstrated of the effectiveness of multiculturalism in ensuring political stability and inclusion, including critiques of multiculturalism.